Review asks the whole crew can run.

Tape this to the shop wall. Stuff it in the truck binder. One sheet. Three moments. No dropped balls.

01 Three moments across every project

CONTRACT SIGNING · DAY ONE

Set the expectation.

"One more thing before we get rolling. When we wrap and you're happy with the work, I'm going to ask you for a Google review. It's how most of our new clients find us. Just want you to know that's part of how we close out every project."

MID-PROJECT · MILESTONE DAY

The check-in.

"Almost there. Once we wrap the final details you're going to get a text from me with that Google review link we talked about. Nothing heavy, just one tap."

FINAL WALKTHROUGH · JOB CLOSE-OUT

The ask + same-day text.

"Last thing. Like I mentioned on day one, I'm going to text you a Google review link tonight. It's the single thing that helps me the most. Totally fine if something comes up and you can't get to it."

SMS (evening of): "Hey [name] this is [your name] with [company]. Thanks again for having us out. Here's the Google review link I mentioned: [short URL]. Appreciate you."

02 Who does what

MOMENT	OWNER / PM	LEAD INSTALLER / FOREMAN	OFFICE / CRM
Contract signing	Delivers the expectation line in person during paperwork	Not involved yet	Logs contract signed, fires day-one welcome email from CRM
Mid-project milestone	Drops in if on site, reinforces	Delivers the priming line when the milestone hits	Fires milestone reminder text when stage moves to Mid-Project
Final walkthrough	Closes out warranty + review ask in same breath	Reinforces in passing, hands off confidently	Auto-fires same-day SMS + day-3 fallback email
Day-3 fallback	Reviews the tracker weekly	Nothing — the CRM handles it	Email fires automatically if no review yet

Crew bonus + the 2026 rules.

Pay the crew for effort, not the customer for reviews. That keeps you clean with Google and it actually works.

03 Plug-and-play crew bonus

Baseline structure

- **$20-$40 per landed review** (paid to the crew member tied to the project)
- **$100 quarterly bonus** to the crew member with the most reviews (or split if the team is small)
- **Public leaderboard** in the shop — reviews landed by crew, month over month
- Paid monthly, on a regular payroll cycle (not cash, not a gift card)

The rules that keep it legal under Google's March 2026 update

- OK Paying crew for doing the ask correctly and the customer freely leaving a review
- OK Bonuses tied to review *count*, not specific star ratings
- OK Internal leaderboards, recognition, bonuses for crew effort
- NO Offering the customer anything in exchange (discounts, tips back, perks)
- NO Paying bonuses only on 5-star reviews (that's review gating)
- NO Having the crew leave reviews themselves or ask family to leave reviews

04 Don't do this (2026 update)

No incentives to the customer. No discounts, gift cards, raffle entries, free add-ons in exchange for reviews. Retroactive enforcement — old ones can get pulled.
No employee or subcontractor reviews. Not your crew, not the guys you sub to regularly, not office staff. Google cross-references accounts.
No family reviews. Your cousin, brother-in-law, kids. The profile gets flagged.
No AI-generated review text for the customer to paste. Google's detector catches the content itself.
No review gating. Asking "would this be 5 stars?" and only sending the yes group to Google is explicitly banned.
No bulk third-party services. "Get 20 reviews in a week" operations got wiped in the update.

05 Weekly review checklist (tape to clipboard)

All jobs closed this week had the walkthrough ask delivered	☐	Owner
Same-day SMS fired from the CRM on every closed job	☐	CRM auto
Day-3 fallback emails went out where reviews didn't land	☐	CRM auto
Every review received this week has a reply (including 4-star and below)	☐	Owner
Crew bonus log updated (review landed → crew member credited)	☐	Office